

— EDITION 10

From Cowrie Shells to Agentic Wallets

Human history is just a series of upgrades to how we store and pass value. We are about to witness Phase 5.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

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10,000 Years of Ledger Upgrades.

Money evolves whenever the underlying architecture of human trust scales. We are on the precipice of moving value from human networks to software networks.

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Phase 1: Physical Cash & Coins.

Tangible, physical trust. Limited by geography, physical space, and the immediate proximity of the transacting parties.

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Phase 2: Plastic Credit & Card Rails.

Centralized network trust. Built for a world of telephone lines, paper signatures, and trusted institutional clearing houses like Visa and Mastercard.

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Phase 3: Mobile Wallets & Biometric Pay.

Frictionless biometric trust. Apple Pay and Google Wallet condensed financial credentials into secure, localized smartphone hardware tokens.

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Phase 4: Embedded Finance.

Contextual, invisible trust. Financial services dissolved straight into corporate software platforms like Shopify, Uber, and Airbnb.

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Phase 5: Agentic Commerce.

Autonomous, programmatic trust. Value is managed, negotiated, and settled directly by autonomous machine agents operating on behalf of human principals.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Found this **useful?**

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◆ Joseph Bankole